

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 33)

Page 162 - The Spenserian Revival

Q1. How many poems in the Spenserian stanza were published between 1730 and 1775?

- A. Over 20
- B. Over 30
- C. Over 40
- D. Over 50

Answer: D

Q2. Who wrote an emphatic protest in 'The Rambler' against the imitation of Spenser?

- A. Alexander Pope
- B. Samuel Johnson
- C. Joseph Addison
- D. William Shenstone

Answer: B

Q3. On what date was Johnson's protest published in 'The Rambler'?

- A. May 14, 1751
- B. June 15, 1752
- C. April 12, 1750
- D. May 10, 1753

Answer: A

Q4. What world did Spenser help open up for the new generation?

- A. Classical antiquity
- B. Neoclassical philosophy
- C. Chivalry and medieval romance
- D. Realistic urban life

Answer: C

Q5. Who wrote 'The Schoolmistress' (1742, revised 1750)?

- A. James Thomson
- B. William Shenstone

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- C. James Beattie
- D. Samuel Johnson

Answer: B

Q6. For what purpose does 'The Schoolmistress' use the language and style of Spenser?

- A. Serious imitation
- B. Allegory
- C. Burlesque
- D. Religious instruction

Answer: C

Q7. Which poem adopts much of the Gothic machinery of the Faery Queene?

- A. The Castle of Indolence
- B. The Minstrel
- C. The Schoolmistress
- D. The Rambler

Answer: A

Q8. Who wrote 'The Minstrel' (1771-74)?

- A. William Shenstone
- B. James Thomson
- C. James Beattie
- D. Samuel Johnson

Answer: C

Q9. Until well into the 19th century, in what shape was the closed couplet mostly allowed to remain intact?

- A. Dryden's shape
- B. Pope's shape
- C. Milton's shape
- D. Chaucer's shape

Answer: B

Q10. Who were the poets that eventually substituted the loose romantic type for the Popean couplet?

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- A. Thomson and Beattie
- B. Johnson and Shenstone
- C. Leigh Hunt and Keats
- D. Wordsworth and Coleridge

Answer: C

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Page 163 - The Growth of the Love of Nature

Q1. Between which two poets is the growth of a love of nature a marked feature in English poetry?

- A. Dryden and Pope
- B. Pope and Wordsworth
- C. Wordsworth and Keats
- D. Milton and Dryden

Answer: B

Q2. Who were referred to as the 'survivors of the giant race before the flood'?

- A. Milton and Marvell
- B. Parnell and Winchilsea
- C. Addison and Steele
- D. Pope and Swift

Answer: A

Q3. Which of the following poets showed a genuine sense of natural beauty during the Augustan age?

- A. Alexander Pope
- B. Thomas Parnell
- C. Samuel Johnson
- D. John Dryden

Answer: B

Q4. In general terms, what was English Augustan poetry primarily concerned with?

- A. Rural landscapes
- B. City life
- C. Mountaineering
- D. Marine exploration

Answer: B

Q5. Where did the muse of the Augustan time prefer to frequent?

- A. Coffee-house and drawing-room
- B. Rivers and lakes

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- C. Forests and hills
- D. Castles and ruins

Answer: A

Q6. How did the refined taste of the generation view nature in its wilder and more rugged aspects?

- A. It admired it
- B. It was shocked by it
- C. It painted it often
- D. It romanticized it

Answer: B

Q7. According to Addison, when are the works of nature the more pleasing?

- A. When they are completely wild
- B. When they resemble art
- C. When they lack symmetry
- D. When they are untamed

Answer: B

Q8. Which group of poets in the 15th century painted landscape directly from reality rather than conventions?

- A. English poets
- B. Scottish poets
- C. Welsh poets
- D. Irish poets

Answer: B

Q9. Who wrote the real pastoral poem 'The Gentle Shepherd' (1725)?

- A. James Thomson
- B. Allan Ramsay
- C. Thomas Parnell
- D. John Dyer

Answer: B

Q10. In 'The Gentle Shepherd', who are the characters?

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- A. Traditional shadows of a literary Arcadia
- B. Mythological figures
- C. Genuine shepherds and shepherdesses
- D. Kings and Queens in disguise

Answer: C

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Page 164 - The Growth of the Love of Nature (Continued)

Q1. Who wrote the descriptive poem in four parts called 'The Seasons'?

- A. Allan Ramsay
- B. James Thomson
- C. John Dyer
- D. William Collins

Answer: B

Q2. In what years was Thomson's 'The Seasons' published?

- A. 1715-1719
- B. 1726-1730
- C. 1735-1739
- D. 1740-1744

Answer: B

Q3. How is Thomson's style in 'The Seasons' often described due to its poetic conventions?

- A. Simple and natural
- B. Frigid and bombastic
- C. Terse and epigrammatic
- D. Loose and romantic

Answer: B

Q4. 'The Seasons' is historically claimed as the first really important poem where:

- A. Nature is subordinated to man
- B. Nature is made the central theme
- C. Only city life is depicted
- D. Blank verse is not used

Answer: B

Q5. Who wrote the descriptive poem 'Grongar Hill'?

- A. James Thomson
- B. John Dyer

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C. Allan Ramsay

D. William Blake

Answer: B

Q6. What nationality was John Dyer?

A. Scottish

B. English

C. Welsh

D. Irish

Answer: C

Q7. In what year was 'Grongar Hill' published?

A. The same year as Thomson's Spring

B. The same year as Thomson's Winter

C. The same year as Ramsay's The Gentle Shepherd

D. The same year as Beattie's The Minstrel

Answer: B

Q8. The 'return to nature' meant a rising sense of all that is implied in the contrast between:

A. Nature and civilisation

B. Good and evil

C. Poetry and prose

D. Reason and emotion

Answer: A

Q9. What did the 'return to nature' suggest was the only way of salvation for men and nations?

A. Complex urban development

B. A radical simplification of life

C. Strict adherence to rules

D. Expansion of the empire

Answer: B

Q10. Where did poets seeking more elementary themes turn to?

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- A. The recognised centres of culture
- B. Unsophisticated country-folk
- C. Classical literature
- D. Historical ruins

Answer: B

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Page 165 - The Development of Naturalism

Q1. Which of the following was a principal object aimed at by poets of the new generation?

- A. Greater complexity in passions described
- B. Greater simplicity in the language employed
- C. Reverting to Latinized vocabulary
- D. Writing strictly in closed couplets

Answer: B

Q2. The utmost stress in the naturalistic reaction must be laid upon the attempt to bring poetry back to:

- A. The drawing-room
- B. Augustan traditions
- C. Nature and reality
- D. The Middle Ages

Answer: C

Q3. On the side of matter and style, simplification was much aided by the spread of an interest in:

- A. Epic literature
- B. Old ballad literature
- C. Metaphysical poetry
- D. Classical drama

Answer: B

Q4. Which Augustan critic perceived that the informality of 'Chevy Chase' gave it a wonderful power of appeal?

- A. Samuel Johnson
- B. Joseph Addison
- C. Alexander Pope
- D. John Dryden

Answer: B

Q5. What old ballad did Addison praise alongside 'Chevy Chase'?

- A. Sir Patrick Spens

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- B. The Babes in the Wood
- C. Robin Hood
- D. The Nut-Brown Maid

Answer: B

Q6. How had the Augustans 'refined' the old ballad phrase 'God rest his soul'?

- A. 'May his spirit find peace'
- B. 'Eternal blessings on his shade attend'
- C. 'Heaven protect his spirit'
- D. 'May angels guide his flight'

Answer: B

Q7. What was Samuel Johnson's general attitude toward the old ballads?

- A. He highly praised them
- B. He imitated them in his works
- C. He ridiculed them
- D. He considered them the peak of English literature

Answer: C

Q8. People began to discover that the simpler form of the old ballads was:

- A. Worse than the translation
- B. Much better and more poetical than the translation
- C. Too archaic to understand
- D. Unfit for serious reading

Answer: B

Q9. Who 'polished' some of the old ballads in his collection as a concession to the extreme refinement of his age?

- A. Thomas Percy
- B. Joseph Addison
- C. Samuel Johnson
- D. Allan Ramsay

Answer: A

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Q10. The discovery of the superiority of natural poetry led to a change of taste that was fatal to:

- A. The Romantic movement
- B. The Elizabethan revival
- C. The theories of the Augustan school
- D. The Spenserian stanza

Answer: C

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Page 166 - Blake and Crabbe

Q1. Who is described as a mystic and a visionary whose effusions were inspired by the desire to restore the golden age?

- A. William Cowper
- B. William Blake
- C. George Crabbe
- D. Robert Burns

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following works is NOT by William Blake?

- A. Poetical Sketches
- B. Songs of Innocence
- C. Songs of Experience
- D. The Borough

Answer: D

Q3. Blake is considered a leader in the poetry of ordinary things, which was later brought to perfection by:

- A. John Keats
- B. Lord Byron
- C. William Wordsworth
- D. Percy Bysshe Shelley

Answer: C

Q4. Who was a contemporary of Blake known for uncompromising realism?

- A. George Crabbe
- B. Robert Burns
- C. James Beattie
- D. Thomas Gray

Answer: A

Q5. Which of these works was written by George Crabbe?

- A. The Castle of Indolence

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- B. The Village
- C. The Minstrel
- D. Songs of Innocence

Answer: B

Q6. For many years, what was George Crabbe's occupation?

- A. A London merchant
- B. A hard-working parish clergyman
- C. A political writer
- D. A university professor

Answer: B

Q7. What was Crabbe's programmatic principle in depicting the life of the poor?

- A. Idealising their struggles
- B. Unflinching fidelity to facts
- C. Imitating pastoral conventions
- D. Romanticizing their poverty

Answer: B

Q8. How did the romantic movement influence Crabbe?

- A. He was heavily influenced by it
- B. He led the movement
- C. He remained entirely uninfluenced by it
- D. He incorporated its mysticism

Answer: C

Q9. What poetic form did Crabbe regularly employ?

- A. The Spenserian stanza
- B. Blank verse
- C. The closed couplet
- D. The ballad stanza

Answer: C

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Q10. The Romantic Revival was a revolt against the hard temper and dry intellectuality of which school?

- A. The Elizabethan school
- B. The Augustan school
- C. The Metaphysical school
- D. The Pre-Raphaelite school

Answer: B